

**REPORT BY LATVIA
ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION
FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND
EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMSIV.**

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Latvia

Organization:

Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Latvia

Date of submission:

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V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Latvia
 National Center for Education
 State Education Quality Service
 Ministry of Environmental Protection and Regional Development
 Ministry of Culture
 Ministry of Foreign Affairs
 Latvian National Commission for UNESCO

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Free Trade Union Confederation of Latvia

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Latvian Platform for Development Cooperation

Others (please specify):

Higher education institutions

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes¹ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Article 112 of the **Constitution of the Republic of Latvia** states that anyone is entitled to education. The State shall ensure that anyone may acquire primary and secondary education without charge.

Pursuant to Article 3.¹ of the **Education Law**, a prohibition of differential treatment is stipulated, thus guaranteeing the persons referred to in Section 3 of the Education Law the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social status, race, nationality, ethnic origin, gender, religious and political affiliation, state of health, occupation and place of residence. Article 10 "Education and Religion" states that the education system shall ensure freedom of conscience. Students shall have the option to acquire Christian religious instruction or ethics, or Christian religious instruction and ethics concurrently.

Article 42 of the **Environmental Protection Law** states that the matters in respect of environmental education and education for sustainable development shall be included in the mandatory curricula of the subject or course standard in accordance with the specific character of each subject by coordinating and ensuring succession on different education levels. The environmental protection course shall be included in the mandatory part of all study programmes of authorities of higher education and colleges. A course regarding sustainable development shall be included in all higher educations' and colleges' initial study programmes for pedagogues.

According to the 2017 **Cooperation agreement between the Ministry of Education and Science, the Ministry of Environmental Protection and Regional Development and the Latvian National Commission for UNESCO**, the Parties agreed to cooperate within the implementation of the Global Action Programme (GAP) on Education for Sustainable Development in order to achieve the main goals:

- reorienting education and learning so that everyone has the opportunity to acquire the knowledge, skills, values and attitudes that empower them to contribute to a sustainable future.
- strengthening education and learning in all agendas, programmes and activities that promote sustainable development.

The Parties agreed to:

- foster implementation of the ESD principles, aims and tasks in normative and policy planning documents,
- foster inclusion of ESD in curricula of formal and non-formal education of all levels,
- promote positive attitude and understanding about ESD and environmental education in wider society,
- develop informative and methodological materials on ESD,
- support research on sustainable development,
- promote national and international cooperation on GAP,
- promote exchange of information on activities related to the GAP.

In addition, each Party have specific duties in regards to the Agreement.

¹ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

The Constitution of the Republic of Latvia (*Satversme*) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/57980-the-constitution-of-the-republic-of-latvia>

The Education Law - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>

The Environmental Protection Law - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/147917-environmental-protection-law>

Cooperation agreement between the Ministry of Education and Science, the Ministry of Environmental Protection and Regional Development and the Latvian National Commission for UNESCO – not available online.

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national*			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal**	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
3. Human rights	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
5. Climate change	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	99	99	99	99	99

* In Latvia, legislation regulates the education content at the national level.

** According to the Education Law, non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. GCED and ESD non-formal education and awareness rising activities are mainly provided by the relevant responsible authorities, NGO active citizenship organizations and other

stakeholders. Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED and ESD are an integral part of many events.

A3a Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The Sustainable Development Strategy of Latvia until 2030 envisages sustainable welfare-state. It outlines the sustainable development objectives of Latvia and the main action directions for the next 20 years. The strategy addresses different groups of the society – the inhabitants, households, state administrative and public sector. The Strategy focuses on promotion of sustainable lifestyle. Environmental education may become a significant promoter of sustainable lifestyle, educating students about the necessity and possibilities to change their everyday practice, as well as to promote participation in activities of sustainable lifestyle. The Strategy also emphasizes the importance of citizens' participation, civic education and social integration, touching upon such aspects as social sciences, civic participation programmes, discussions on actual topics, social diversity, etc.

National Development Plan of Latvia for 2021-2027 defines the vision for the future of Latvia, including the knowledge society as a mutual direction for change in education and science, civic awareness, the media space and the economy. It also emphasizes the importance of ensuring sustainability for future generations. The Plan includes the activities for effective introduction of new curricula and approaches in general education with particular focus on digital skills, sustainable development, entrepreneurship, etc.

Development Cooperation Policy Guidelines for 2016-2020 explicitly state as one of its objectives the raising of public awareness of the importance of development cooperation, participation and support for the implementation of the policy. Latvia's development cooperation policy overarching goal is to contribute to the implementation of Agenda 2030 in Latvia's priority partner countries, including the activities related to raising public awareness on sustainable development.

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Republic of Latvia (MFA) annually has an open call for co-funding development cooperation and development (global) education projects. Additionally, MFA provides support to Latvian Association of Local and Regional Governments and Latvian Platform for Development Cooperation in support of activities that raise public awareness on development cooperation, *inter alia* sustainable development.

Currently the new **Development Cooperation Policy Guidelines for 2021-2027** are being developed, defining among the policy objectives raising the public awareness of the importance of development cooperation, participation, and support for the implementation of the policy, as well as emphasizing the inclusion of GCED and ESD topics in education for different age groups.

Since establishment of the UN SDGs, Latvia has worked towards mapping relevant policies, initiatives and activities. Implementation of the ESD and GCED has been seen as an integral part of the Agenda 2030, particularly of the SDG 4: Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all. Throughout 2017, the Cross-Sectoral Coordination Centre – the leading institution in national development planning and coordination in Latvia – organized the SDG mapping and gathering of all relevant data from governmental institutions on existing policies and indicators relevant for implementation of Agenda 2030 in Latvia, including on the SDG4. In 2018, Latvia has produced and presented at the UN High Level Political Forum the **Voluntary National Review on SDGs**. One of its sections includes the information on education.

Education Development Guidelines for 2014-2020 determined the main goal of the education development policy - high-quality and inclusive education for personal development, human welfare, and reaching sustainable national growth. One of the basic principles of the policy is education for sustainable development as a lifelong process, and it encourages people to act responsibly in everyday life and to live and accomplish themselves in accordance with the social, cultural, economic and natural environment around them. The goal of education for sustainable development is a person who not only lives in accordance with nature and in peaceful line with other cultures, but is also able to fully accomplish himself or herself in the economy and in society in general by providing long-term and well-considered use of resources. The Guidelines also included activities for development of active citizenship, particularly among youngsters.

The new **Education Development Guidelines for 2021-2027** are being developed, including the integration of EDS and GCED topics in education policy, development of education process and education environment, professional development of teachers, inclusive approach, and more active involvement of stakeholders, including the local level, promoting effective use of resources and civic participation. The new Guidelines will be oriented towards the creation of an inclusive culture of lifelong learning and fostering the acquisition of skills and competences for employability, individual growth and cohesive social and economic development.

The **Cultural Policy Guidelines 2014-2020 “Creative Latvia”** included the cross-disciplinary strategy in the content of the vocational culture-oriented education policy and higher education in arts, supporting the promotion of ESD. The following priorities were laid down for achieving the overarching objective of the policy: preservation and development of the cultural capital promoting participation of the society in cultural processes; creativity in lifelong learning and cultural education oriented towards labour market; competitive cultural and creative industries; creative territories and access to cultural services.

The new **Cultural Policy Guidelines for 2021-2027** are being developed, including the availability of cultural services to all groups of society, aiming to provide the public with opportunities to participate in cultural processes, to ensure the conditions for sustainability and development of cultural industries and to ensure the sustainability and development of cultural education.

The Latvian National Commission for UNESCO together with the Ministry of Education and Science coordinates the **Advisory Council “Education for All”** that focuses on the implementation of the Education 2030 Framework for Action and SDG 4, including the SDG 4.7 on global citizenship and education for sustainable development. The Council facilitates co-operation and coherence of activities between ministries and other institutions, local municipalities, the private sector, non-governmental and international organisations. It develops provides a discussion platform to promote effective education policy and to ensure inclusive, equitable and high-quality education, lifelong learning and sustainable development.

In 2018, a programme of the **Global Education Network Europe (GENE)** for increasing awareness of global education was launched in Latvia. Its goal is to promote the civic responsibility, understanding of the global processes and active participation for the creation of fair, inclusive and sustainable society. The implementation of the GENE in Latvia included an open call for projects of general education institutions to promote global education in Latvia through development of teaching materials and activities to raise awareness of global challenges. The programme also included additional activities intended to raise awareness, as well as to foster

discussions on these issues among policy makers, municipalities, NGOs and educational institutions.

Non-formal education of ESD (of biodiversity content) is offered by **national environmental education centres** (Riga Zoo, the Latvian National Museum of Natural History and the National Botanic Garden) and by the Nature Conservation Agency (providing teaching materials, nature education centres and more than 400 nature trails and other objects).

Latvian Environmental Protection Fund of the State Regional Development Agency as a state institution supports financially *inter alia* environmental communication and education projects as well as co-finances the EU LIFE programme nature, environmental and climate information projects every year.

A3b. **Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.**

Sustainable Development Strategy of Latvia until 2030 -

https://www.pkc.gov.lv/sites/default/files/inline-files/LIAS_2030_en_0.pdf

National Development Plan of Latvia for 2021-2027 -

https://www.pkc.gov.lv/sites/default/files/inline-files/NAP2027_ENG.pdf

Development Cooperation Policy Guidelines for 2016-2020

Latvia: Implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals -

https://www.pkc.gov.lv/sites/default/files/inline-files/Latvia%20Implementation%20of%20the%20SDGs_4.pdf

Education Development Guidelines 2014-2020 (Latvian only) -

<https://likumi.lv/doc.php?id=266406>

Cultural Policy Guidelines 2014-2020 “Creative Latvia” -

<https://www.km.gov.lv/en/media/1350/download>

Regulation on the Advisory Council “Education for All” (Latvian only) -

<https://likumi.lv/ta/id/79116-konsultativas-padomes-izglitiba-visiem-nolikums>

Global Education Network Europe (GENE) - <https://www.gene.eu/what-we-do>

Latvian Environmental Protection Fund (Latvian only) - <https://lvafa.vraa.gov.lv/>

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education*
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

* In Latvia, according to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Non-formal education should be implemented in the line of the principles defined in the Education Development Guidelines.

Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED and ESD are an integral part of many events.

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	99
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	99
Textbook development	1	1	1	99
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	99
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	99
Sub-national*				
Design or revision of the curricula	99	99	99	99
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	99	99	99
Textbook development	99	99	99	99
Teacher education and training	99	99	99	99
Assessment of student outcomes	99	99	99	99

* In Latvia, education policies and strategic objectives for curricula, textbook development, teacher education, assessment of students' outcomes etc. are defined at the national level.

** According to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Non-formal education should be implemented in the line of the principles defined in the Education Development Guidelines. There are no formal education and professional development requirements for the non-formal education educators. However the EPALE national contact point provides information activities on EDS and GCED themes for adult educators. Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED and ESD are an integral part of many events.

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the 1974 Recommendation)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The paradigm of education for sustainable development and global citizenship education is reflected in Latvia's new competence-based curricula, which will be fully implemented by 2023, modernizing school education in terms of curricula, teaching methods and teaching/learning materials. The new curricula provides a more integrated and streamlined learning of discipline-based subjects with stronger focus on application of knowledge, independent reasoning and creativity. The learning process is built on attitudes and values of responsible citizenship - ability to express one's position on social, economic and political processes, take responsible decisions and have a positive impact on welfare locally and globally, recognize injustice and act to prevent it, treat with tolerance different cultures and their heritage.

In order to introduce the new competence-based approach in general education curricula, the following regulations have been approved by the Cabinet of Ministers:

- (1) Regulation No.716 of 21 November 2018 "**Regulations Regarding the State Guidelines for Pre-school Education and the Model Pre-school Education Programmes**",
 - (2) Regulation No. 747 of November 27, 2018 "**Regulations Regarding the State Basic Education Standard and Model Basic Education Programmes**" (in force from 1 September 2020),
 - (3) Regulations No. 416 of September 3, 2019 "**Regulations Regarding the State General Secondary Education Standard and Model General Secondary Education Programmes**".
- According to these Regulations, issues on GCED and ESD are integrated in general education curricula.

The issues of GCED and ESD are also integrated in the new Regulations of the Cabinet of Ministers No 332 "**State Standard for Vocational Education**" accepted on June 2, 2020.

According to the **State Standard for the First Level Professional Higher Education** the mandatory content of first level professional higher education programme includes natural, social and human sciences.

According to the **State Standard for the Second Level Professional Higher Education** the strategic objectives of a programme are to ensure professional studies according to the state economic, cultural, security and social needs; and to ensure professional studies that are firmly based on the scientific theoretic foundations of the branch, conform to profession standards and are practically applicable. The main task of the programmes is to educate fifth level professional qualification specialists and to promote their competitiveness in changeable socio-economic conditions and the international labour market. The compulsory content of a Professional Bachelor's and Master's study programmes includes knowledge of humanitarian and social sciences, including such topics, which develop social, communicative and organisational skills. Also in the content of study programmes there is included an entrepreneurship module, which develops such knowledge and skills as innovations, company administration and foundation, management methods, business economics, project development, skills in creative activity, research, organisation and quality management. In addition, it is obligatory in curricula of professional bachelor and professional master study programmes, in accordance with Environmental Protection Law and Civil Protection Law, to include such issues as civil protection, environmental education and education for sustainable development.

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

State Standard for Academic Education defines that curricula of bachelor and master study programmes, in accordance with the Environmental Protection Law and the Civil Protection Law, must include such issues as civil protection, environmental education and education for sustainable development.

Higher education institutions in Latvia are autonomous. The autonomy of an institution of higher education is expressed in the right to select the ways and forms for the implementation of the tasks in the frames of the national regulations. Some of higher education study directions directly correspond to the GCED and ESD issues, for example: natural sciences; social welfare; environmental protection.

Article 42 of the **Environmental Protection Law** states that the matters in respect of environmental education and education for sustainable development shall be included in the mandatory curricula of the subject or course standard in accordance with the specific character of each subject by coordinating and ensuring succession on different education levels. The environmental protection course shall be included in the mandatory part of all study programmes of authorities of higher education and colleges. A course regarding sustainable development shall be included in all higher educations' and colleges' initial study programmes for pedagogues.

On 15 July 2016, the Cabinet of Ministers adopted Regulation No. 480 "**Guidelines for the upbringing of learners and the procedure for evaluating information, teaching aids, materials and teaching methods**". The Regulation stipulates that the task of upbringing in the education process includes promotion of the ability of learners to think freely and independently, thereby developing critical thinking, judgment and promoting responsible behaviour, respect towards life, oneself and others, developing health-promoting and safe habits, civic participation in strengthening a democratic society, responsibility for the protection and sustainability of nature and the environment.

Each subject programme describes the teaching methods. Teachers may choose the most appropriate method for their teaching process. The choice of the teaching/learning methods also depends on the age of the students. For example, the primary schools more often use game-based approach, but secondary schools use mostly discussions. Scientific inquiry is the most commonly used method for science classes, regardless of the age of students. Schools also receive various teaching materials, they are also available digitally, which already offers teaching/learning methods for appropriate learning subjects.

The accumulated experience shows that the most effective study methods are interactive methods which are based on dialogue approach and problem-based approach in study process and promote the development of ecological thinking and ecological competence, including responsibility for sustainable development and correct decision-making.

In higher education, according to the principle of academic freedom each lecturer / professor may choose the most appropriate methods for teaching and learning.

The tasks of upbringing and value education should be included in the development plan of the education institution, as well as for each education institution (except higher education institutions), the directions of upbringing work for a three-year period and a plan of upbringing for each academic year should be developed.

Education institutions are also obliged to fulfil their development strategies, including ESD issues. Due to the accreditation process every school has to describe their further development needs which are presented in a self-assessment report for accreditation experts of the State Education Quality Service. Thus the ESD issues are included in the education institution working plan for three years period. Every education institution has to describe how to promote citizenship, democracy and governance, human rights, environmental protection, ecological principles, health, social responsibility and economics and some other ESD issues in their everyday teaching and upbringing process.

Altogether, the State Education Quality Service in the accreditation process evaluates education institution quality by using the criteria which include ESD issues.

In both Education Development Guidelines and Cultural Policy Guidelines a task to improve the access to cultural events for all students in order to develop cultural awareness and expression competence has been included and emphasized. A national cultural education program "Latvian School Bag" has been developed and implemented since September 2018 as cultural awareness has a strong impact on students' ability to learn social, civic and intercultural competences and develop sense of initiative and entrepreneurship. All students attend cultural events, such as theatrical performances, concerts, exhibitions, museum programs etc. including contemporary artistic expressions as part of formal education process that provides additional material and allows to improve discussions and understanding of issues of cultural diversity, human rights, tolerance, environmental sustainability and climate change etc.

Through arts and cultural activities students can experience cultural diversity, which can enhance mutual understanding and strengthen cohesion within communities locally and globally. Access to cultural events also provides a basis for practicing critical thinking, medial literacy and other transversal skills that are crucial in educational process of the 21st century.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

State Guidelines for Pre-school Education and the Model Pre-school Education Programmes - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/303371-regulations-regarding-the-state-guidelines-for-pre-school-education-and-the-model-pre-school-education-programmes>

State Basic Education Standard and Model Basic Education Programmes - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/303768-regulations-regarding-the-state-basic-education-standard-and-model-basic-education-programmes>

State General Secondary Education Standard and Model General Secondary Education Programmes - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/309597-regulations-regarding-the-state-general-secondary-education-standard-and-model-general-secondary-education-programmes>

State Standard for Vocational Education (Latvian only) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/315146-noteikumi-par-valsts-profesionalas-videjas-izglitiba-standartu-un-valsts-arodizglitiba-standartu>

State Standard for the First Level Professional Higher Education (Latvian only) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/6397-noteikumi-par-pirma-limena-profesionalas-augstakas-izglitiba-valsts-standartu>

State Standard for the Second Level Professional Higher Education (Latvian only) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/268761-noteikumi-par-otra-limena-profesionalas-augstakas-izglitiba-valsts-standartu>

State Standard for Academic Education (Latvian only) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/266187-noteikumi-par-valsts-akademiskas-izglitiba-standartu>

The Environmental Protection Law - <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/147917-environmental-protection-law>

Guidelines for the upbringing of learners and the procedure for evaluating information, teaching aids, materials and teaching methods (Latvian only) - <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/283735-guidelines-for-the-upbringing-of-learners-and-the-procedure-for-evaluating-information-teaching-aids-materials-and-teaching-methods>

[izglitotamo-audzinasanas-vadlinijas-un-informacijas-macibu-lidzeklu-materialu-un-macibu-un-audzinasanas-metozu-izvertesanas](#)

*B2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education*
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	9
5. Climate change	1	1	1	9
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	9
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	9
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	9

* In Latvia, according to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Non-formal education should be implemented in the line of the principles defined in the Education Development Guidelines.

Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED and ESD are an integral part of many events.

*B3 Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	9	9	9	9	1	9	1
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	9	9	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	9	9	1	9
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	9	1	1	1	9	1	1	9
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Languages	1	1	1	9	9	9	9	9
Mathematics	9	9	9	9	9	1	1	1
Religious education	1	1	1	1	9	9	1	9
Science	1	1	9	9	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

*B4 Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education*
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	9
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	9
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	9

* In Latvia, according to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Non-formal education should be implemented in the line of the principles defined in the Education Development Guidelines.

Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED and ESD are an integral part of many events.

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

In Latvia, GCED and ESD topics are included both in teachers' initial training and in in-service training (professional development).

In order to improve initial training of teachers and motivate new teachers, a restart of initial education model of teachers has been initiated with the aim to prepare modern, competent and values-oriented teachers. The new teachers' initial education programmes will be research-based, connected with the new competence-based approach to education, elements of inclusive education, needs of students, schools and society, will have more time for practice at schools, etc.

Higher education institutions are autonomous and have the right to select the ways and forms for the implementation of the tasks in the frames of the national regulations. The level of implementation of ESD depends on the study programme of the specific higher education institution. Latvian higher education institutions that are implementing pedagogy programmes, have included ESD both as separated study course and theoretical specialization.

Professional development is an obligatory part of teacher's work. National Centre for Education ensures professional development courses for teachers within the state budget programme, including on the GCED and/or ESD related issues. For example, within the course programmes on the implementation of competence-based approach, working in the team of teachers, preparation of teaching consultants for the needs of the regions, preparation of professional development experts for the implementation of competence-based approach in schools, current human security issues, etc.

One of the main objectives of the European Social Fund project "Competence-based approach to education content" is to ensure the effective planning of teachers work and cooperation at school. It is crucially important, considering that as a result of this project it is planned to provide schools with more freedom regarding the organization of teaching process, combining various thematic modules and integrating various lessons, ensuring that students will get deeper experience within the exercises, projects, learning trips, etc. Within this project the support is provided to professional development of teachers (altogether around 6000 teachers are planned to receive support), promoting their ability to successfully implement the new education content, including GCED/ESD related issues.

ESD/GCED is a part of training of leaders and administrators of education institutions, developing appropriate competences.

Also, the State Education Quality Service promotes the quality of education in education institutions by laying emphasis on support measures and new methods of how to approach any malfunctions and failures. The leaders of education institution are one of the target groups of training organized by the Service. According to the quality assurance criteria of education institutions and / or programmes ESD issues are included in these trainings' content. These training programmes are optional.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

The requirements for teachers are based on the Regulation of the Cabinet of Ministers of Latvia No. 569, adopted on 11 September 2018, "Regulations regarding the education and professional qualification required for teachers, and the procedure of teachers' professional competence improvement" (available in Latvian here: <https://likumi.lv/ta/id/301572-noteikumi-par-pedagogiem-nepieciessamo-izglitiba-un-profesionalo-kvalifikaciju-un-pedagogu-profesionalas-kompetences-pilnveides>), which define the education and professional qualifications necessary for a teacher and the procedure for the improvement of professional competence of teachers.

University of Liepaja

2010-2019 – study course "Philosophy of sustainable development" (1 credit point) was included in bachelor's study programme "Teacher";

2012-2019 – study course "Sustainable development" (1 credit point) was included in professional master's programme "General education teacher";

2015-2020 – study course "Education for sustainable development" was included in teachers' professional development programme "Pedagogy" (72 h).

Daugavpils University

2006-2020 – within professional master's programme "Education" the opportunity was provided to study in sector "Environment and sustainable education", including study courses "Theoretical basis of chosen pedagogical sector: environment and sustainable development" (5 credit points) and "Approbation of theoretical basis of chosen pedagogical sector" (3 credit points).

University of Latvia

2014-2020 – study course "Education for sustainable cultural environment" (3 credit points) was included in professional master's programme "Teacher".

ESD aspects are included in the content of many other teachers' study programmes at bachelor's, master's and doctoral level. Higher education institutions, which are implementing initial education programmes for teachers, supported the inclusion of study course "Introduction to the education for sustainable development" in bachelor's level programmes for teachers and study course "Education for sustainable development" in master's level programmes for teachers. The implementation of these study courses remain the choice of particular higher education institutions.

More information (in Latvian): <https://unesco.lv/lv/izglitiba/pieejama-publikacija-par-izglitiba-ilgtspējīgai-attīstībai-skolotāju-izglītībai/>

National Centre for Education – information on professional development possibilities for teachers: <https://www.visc.gov.lv/lv/jaunumi?category%5B82%5D=82&created%5Bmin%5D=---.-.----&created%5Bmax%5D=---.-.---->

The NGO sector also plays an important role in professional development of teachers on ESD/GCED/SDGs issues in education.

Several networks have been established, for example, the Interdisciplinary National Coalition for Implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals lead by the Latvian Platform for Development Cooperation (<https://lapas.lv/en/home/>). It unites non-governmental and governmental institutions, municipalities and individuals. The coalition shares relevant information, opportunities for cooperation and best practices. It also involves education institutions, as well as other organizations that provide training activities on SDGs.

NGO Center for Education Initiatives (CEI) has been founded with the goal to promote changes in the community's perception about the role of education in creating human rights society and to promote the development of the further education in Latvia without reference to people's nationality, race, social status, religion and sex, as well as the physical and mental level of development. The Center implements various projects on the topics of SDGs and teachers are one of their target groups. More information: <http://iic.lv/about-cei/>

Green Liberty ("Zaļā brīvība" in Latvian) is a non-profit NGO, founded in 1993. It's mission is to contribute to the development of a society, where people live in harmony with each other and the environment. Green Liberty works in global education via projects that are focused on media, solidarity economy, fair trade, and sustainable tropical fruits and supermarket private label products. It organizes CSO seminars, workshops and lectures. People are actively engaged in discussing development issues, informing them about interconnections between development and environmental issues, and global impacts of local processes. More information: <https://www.zalabriviba.lv/>

Other examples of teachers' cooperation include Children's Environmental School (<http://www.videsskola.lv/>), Association of Environmental Educators, Fund of Environmental Education (<http://www.videsfonds.lv/lv/s-kums>) and Institute of Sustainable Education (http://www.ise-lv.eu/index.php?sub_show=59&show=).

School networks

Latvia engages in the Global Network of EcoSchools⁴ in order to promote the development of environment-friendly schools and learning culture. The international EcoSchool Programme is one of the most comprehensive and also the most popular environmental education models in the world. EcoSchools are an open and democratic programme with the aim to promote establishment of environment-friendly management of schools, enhance environmental awareness, develop attitudes, values and interests on environmental issues and the willingness to act, thus contributing to the development of a common environmental awareness in the society.

Currently there are almost 200 education institutions in Latvia, ranging from pre-primary education institutions to universities that have acquired the Green Flag of the EcoSchool. More information: <https://www.ecoschools.global/>

The UNESCO Associated School Project network in Latvia organizes special seminars, workshops and other activities for teachers, principals, students related to different dimensions of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development. The project theme is related to different aspects of value education, environmental education, principles of human rights and promotes safeguarding the world's cultural and natural heritage. More information: www.skolas.unesco.lv

The Baltic Sea project is an international network among young people and teachers for a better environment in the Baltic Sea catchment area. More information: www.b-s-p.org.

Company "Zaļa josta" provides environmental education materials (including video, games, etc.), that can be used by teachers: <http://www.zalajosta.lv/lv/vides-izglitiba-materiali>

⁴ Supported by the Memorandum of Cooperation between the Ministry of Environmental Protection and Regional Development and the Fund of Environmental Education (the representative of Foundation for Environmental Education (FEE International) in Latvia). The fund implements all programmes of the FEE International (Green Key, Blue Flag, Young Reporters, Learning about Forests, Eco-Schools) in Latvia.

- *C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1

- *C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

- *C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

- *C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

According to the introduction of the new competence-based general education content and structural developments in vocational education and the new education standards (for more information please see part B), the assessment / examination process is also being improved. That includes GCED/ESD issues regarding knowledge, skills and competences, values and attitudes, behaviours, which can be tested within students' assessments and examinations.

In higher education such approach to student assessment should be implemented and is relevant for study programmes, which are designed according to expected study programme outcomes. In accordance with the Law on Institutions of Higher Education learning outcomes are defined for each study programme, study module and study course. State standards for higher education (both, academic and professional HE) require to incorporate topics on environment and sustainable development, in all teacher training study programs a course on sustainable development.

Latvian level descriptions of knowledge (knowledge and comprehension), skills (ability to apply knowledge, communication, and general skills), and competence (analysis, synthesis and assessment) for referencing to the European Qualifications Framework are incorporated into the Cabinet of Ministers Regulations No 990 on Regulations on the classification of Latvian education (available here in Latvian: <http://likumi.lv/doc.php?id=184810>).

Latvia currently is within a process of development of the Education Quality Monitoring System, which will be based on statistical information, the results of comparative research, indicators of state level students achievements and other indicators of education institutions' work, centralized examinations, accreditation / licensing, teachers' work quality, considering mid-term and long-term strategical goals and results. This System will provide a comprehensive contribution to policy planning and implementation, including regarding GCED/ESD.

One of the elements of the Latvian Education Quality Monitoring System is participation in worldwide students' assessment – Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development

(OECD) Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA), which takes place every three years and provides assessment of 15 year old students' knowledge in reading, mathematics, science, as well as various factors of school environment and students' school life. PISA also provides possibilities for additional assessments (innovative domains, international modules). PISA 2018 study included Global Competence as the innovative domain of the study. It covered the assessment of knowledge and skills in global competence, as well as self-reported data on students' attitudes, learning opportunities at school, the existence of a dedicated curricula, and information from schools, teachers and parents on activities to promote global competence. Within this study, global competence was defined as the capability and disposition to act and interact appropriately and effectively, both individually and collaboratively, when participating in an interconnected, interdependent and diverse world.

PISA 2018 Global Competence study showed the following results for Latvia:

- 93% of students use two or more languages on daily basis;
- 53% of students would like to explore other cultures;
- 75% of students are aware of global challenges, for example, famine and poverty;
- 72% of students are aware of gender equality challenges in different parts of the world;
- 75% of students are aware of causes of climate change;
- 76% of students are aware of the effect of economic development on environment.

***D2** Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary*	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	9
5. Climate change	1	1	1	9
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	9
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	9
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	9

* In Latvia, within the pre-school education process the education institution independently develops the procedures for evaluating learning achievements of a child according to the basic principles for the evaluation in pre-school education specified in the State guidelines for pre-school education (see part B).

** According to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Therefore the inclusion of GCED /ESD in the assessments depends on the particular programme and its organizer.

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary*	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
Knowledge	1	1	1	9
Skills	1	1	1	9
Values	1	1	1	9
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	9

* In Latvia, within the pre-school education process the education institution independently develops the procedures for evaluating learning achievements of a child according to the basic principles for the evaluation in pre-school education specified in the State guidelines for pre-school education (see part B).

** According to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Therefore the inclusion of dimensions of the GCED /ESD in the assessments depends on the particular programme and its organizer.

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	2	2	2	99
(b) Curricula	2	2	2	99
(c) Teacher education	2	2	2	99
(d) Student assessment	2	2	2	99
Sub-national*				
(a) Education laws and policies	99	99	99	99
(b) Curricula	99	99	99	99
(c) Teacher education	99	99	99	99
(d) Student assessment	99	99	99	99

* In Latvia, legislation regulates the education content at the national level.

** According to the Education Law non-formal education - education activities in conformity with interests and demand are organised outside the formal education. Non-formal education includes interest-related education programmes (traditionally organised for children and youth under the guidance of teachers) and non-formal adult education programmes. Non-formal education programmes are made in compliance with social demand both in the fields related to professional activities and when directed towards personal interests of the population. Non-formal education should be implemented in the line of the principles defined in the Education Development Guidelines.

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

Informal learning is an education process which includes acquisition of new knowledge, skills, competences, attitudes, and values from daily experience and work experience enriching and enhancing the personality and, perhaps, work skills; however, unlike non-formal education, informal learning is not included within the programme or training course, it takes place in society including one's family, as well as at work (for example, when finding out new information from TV broadcasts, visiting libraries, museums, and exhibitions, adopting the parental or friends' experience). The state does not regulate informal learning. However, GCED / ESD is an integral part of many activities.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 Recommendation)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

According to the Regulations of the Cabinet of Ministers No 332 "State Standard for Vocational Education" accepted on June 2, 2020, GCED / ESD issues are integrated in VET.

Vocational education content reform is being implemented, ensuring a transition from subject-based vocational education curricula to result-based learning, as well as introducing a modular approach in the implementation of vocational education programmes and strengthening work-based learning, including the following activities:

- The ESF-supported project *Establishment of Sectoral Qualifications System and Enhancement of Efficiency and Quality of Vocational Education* has been implemented since the end of 2016. The project improves the sectoral qualification system and to prepare descriptions, to develop and improve 200 professional standards and professional qualification requirements, develop and introduce 185 modular vocational education programmes and develop content of professional qualification exams for 206 professional qualifications, as well as develop relevant teaching aids and methodological materials.

- The implementation of the developed modular vocational education programmes is ensured in areas such as finishing work and dry construction, forestry, crop production and horticulture, digital printing, renewable energy, customer service, financial and accounting started in school year 2019/2020.

- ESF funded project *Increasing the Number of Qualified Students in Vocational Education Institutions after their Participation on Work-Based Learning and Apprenticeships in an Enterprise* is being implemented in order to promote the introduction of work-based learning. By the end of 2023, within this project support will be provided for engaging 3 150 unique students in work-based learning and 11 025 unique students in apprenticeship in an enterprise.

- The Erasmus+ programme project *Testing New Approaches to Training VET and Workplace Tutors for Work Based Learning (TTT4WBL)* aiming to support the implementation of work-based learning in Baltic countries, exchanging experience and testing new approaches in joint preparation of supervisors in an education institution and the company was completed in February 2020. Along with already prepared 300 work-based learning supervisors of WB learning from schools and companies, based on improved professional improvement programmes for supervisors of WB learning and apprenticeship and methodical teaching aids, the preparation of WB learning supervisors using the tandem training approach continued (training for 26 more WB learning supervisors using the tandem approach took place in February 2020).

In order to ensure preparation of specialists according to the requirements of the labour market, as a result of the reform of vocational education curricula, regular cooperation mechanisms with social partners and sectoral organisations were created:

Sectoral expert councils with involvement of sectoral experts in the development, implementation of vocational education curricula and evaluation of qualification examinations, as well as in the implementation of reforms in vocational education.

Starting from the beginning of 2016, a collegial advisory institution – convent, has been operating in vocational education institutions. The convent includes the head of vocational education institution, representatives of the ministry, local government, as well as employers and associations thereof, and may also include also a representative of the respective planning region. The aim of this convent is to facilitate development of vocational education institutions setting the strategic direction of their operation in accordance with market demands.

Within the ESF project *Efficient management of vocational education establishments and raising the staff competence* that started in 2016 support is provided to teachers of vocational education institutions, internship supervisors, administration representatives and sectoral experts for the improvement of professional competence (latest news and novelties in sectors, practical pedagogics in the implementation of work-based learning, development and implementation of modular vocational education programmes, increasing of general skills and competences, promotion of continuing education of adults and traineeship in companies).

The Latvian authorities are supportive of GCED /ESD, responsible business conduct and devote efforts to increasing the level of knowledge among entrepreneurs through seminars and conferences promoting the benefits of responsible business conduct and best practices.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

The measures of the *Education Development Guidelines for 2014-2020* were focused on the introduction of the lifelong learning principle, while one of the action lines envisages expanding education opportunities for adults (for example, expanding the second chance education opportunities, support for employers in educating employees, as well as support in raising the qualification of the employed based on employers' requirements, etc.). It will also be continued in the next planning period.

The implementation of GCED and/or ESD principles require an integrated approach, which can be used in adult education, depending on the goals of the particular programme.

The implementation of the *Adult Education Management Model Implementation Plan for 2016-2020* aimed to ensure accessibility of education and its quality for residents irrespective of their age, sex, previous education, place of residence, income level, ethnic origin, functional disorders, and other factors.

An inter-sectoral consultative institution – *Adult Education Management Council*, has been established and is functioning to carry out coordination of the plan and monitor the implementation. It consists of representatives from ministries involved in adult education and other organizations, as well as representatives from social and cooperation partners.

In 2019, the development of project *Adult Education Management Model Implementation Plan for 2021-2026* started in cooperation with stakeholders, incl. social and cooperation partners. There are intentions to pay more attention to the quality of adult education, incl. to definition of the criteria for the quality of non-formal education in the regulatory framework, building understanding at state level of the need for adult education, segmenting of the target group, targeted support measures, as well as possibilities of public-private partnership in the development of adult education will be evaluated.

In 2017, the implementation of ESF project *Improving the Professional Competence of Employed* was started, aiming to improve professional competence of the employed (including self-

employed) aged above 25 and to eliminate any non-compliances in labour force qualification with labour demand, promote competitiveness and increase work productivity of workers.

Adult education project “Sustainable Development of Libraries and Society: We Build This World Ourselves” (2019/2020) has been organized in cooperation with the Library Association of Latvia and the National Library of Latvia and supported by the Ministry of Education and Science in order to reach libraries in different regions of Latvia, organizing regional seminars to promote exchange of experience in relation to achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

The goal of youth policy in Latvia is to build a friendly youth-oriented support system that offers a wide range of possibilities for social inclusion and social cohesion, by promoting the competitiveness of the youth in the social life and labour market. Youth policy in Latvia is based on the following key principles: participation; availability of information; equal opportunities; respect for the interests of young people; favourable economic preconditions; youth integration; mobility and international cooperation.

Policy measures have been introduced to reduce the proportion of youngsters with low basic skills, provide training to the unemployed youth and early school leavers, provide the possibility of obtaining a qualification in a short period of time that corresponds to the labour market requirements, address the inactive youth and promote their social inclusion and competitiveness in the labour market by developing their social, civil, and communicative skills. Policy has also been targeted towards provision of support for approbation of non-formal education programmes at youth centres and educational institutions in cooperation with societies and foundations, and strengthening the competences of the persons involved in the work with youth.

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

Several universities of Latvia and/or their academic staff are the members of the “Baltic and Black Sea Circle Consortium” (BBCC). The aim of this consortium is to promote and realize ESD ideas and conceptions through scientific research activities and improvement of education quality, including teacher education quality, in the process of cooperation and collaboration in the framework of this network.

There are several UNESCO Chairs in Latvia that are working in the fields of ESD and GCED, including: UNESCO Chair on Interplay of Tradition and Innovation in Education for Sustainable Development at Daugavpils University, UNESCO Chair in Sustainable Coastal Development at the University of Latvia, UNESCO Chair on Biosphere and Man at Vidzeme University of Applied Sciences (more information : <https://latvijasdargumi.unesco.lv/en/networks/#map-9>).

In addition to basic research funding, there are two major nationally funded competitive research funding programmes which allowed to foster research linked to ESD – State research programmes and Fundamental and applied research programme.

These funding programmes were linked to nationally defined priority directions in science. There are several priority directions which are directly linked to fostering sustainable development, as well as education in corresponding thematic fields, for instance, during the period of 2014–2017 *Research and sustainable use of local natural resources* and *Sustainable development of the state and society*; and further expanded during the period of 2018–2021: *Climate change, nature protection, environment and sustainable transport*; *Research and sustainable use of local natural resources for the development of a knowledge-based bio-economy*; *Culture of knowledge and innovations for economic sustainability*.

National higher education system and research funding incentives also support and foster student participation and active involvement in research projects, for instance, HE performance based funding model provides direct financial incentives for those HEIs which contribute to the employment of their students (and young researchers in general) in research and creative industries.

Both state and EU Structural funds instruments support better integration between teaching and research in HE, thus further aiming to redefine HEIs as knowledge-hubs.

EU Structural funds' Programmes for Research and Innovation, which were implemented to foster research and development of ESD, included activities such as grants for applied research projects; grants for postdoctoral research; innovation grants for students; support for the development of R&I in Smart Specialization Strategy (RIS3) areas and capacity building of research institutions (including HEIs); support for international cooperation projects in R&I; increase the number of modernised STEM study programmes, including medicine and creative industries; reducing fragmentation of study programmes.

Since 2014, Latvia's national research and innovation (R&I) system has been developed in accordance to the national Smart specialisation strategy (RIS3) focusing R&I on 5 identified priority areas, namely "Knowledge intensive bio-economy", "Smart energy", "Biomedicine, medical technologies and biotechnology", "Smart materials, technology and engineering", "Advanced ICT".

R&I in "Knowledge intensive bio-economy" is focused on sustainable and productive forest growing in changing climatic conditions; full use of wood biomass for chemical processing and energy; innovative, risk-reducing plant and animal breeding technologies; development of innovative high value-added niche products from wood, traditional and unconventional agricultural plant and animal raw materials; technological solutions for the use of plant and animal breeding and processing by-products; food safety.

R&I in "Smart energy" is focused on development of smart grids - development of demand-supply systems, smart buildings, home, appliances and home automation systems; development of next-generation technologies for energy from renewable energy sources; increasing energy efficiency - energy efficiency of building structures, energy efficiency of residential infrastructure elements; sustainable energy for transport - new technologies, accelerating their implementation, electric mobility.

Various public authorities provide support mechanisms and platforms for dissemination of research results, including the Ministry of Education and Science, higher education institutions, other public sector institutions (sectoral ministries, agencies,), as well as social partners (associations, unions), including the following:

- 4th World Congress of Latvian Scientists organised by the Ministry of Education and Science in June 2018.
- Each year since 2012 State Education Development Agency has organised Researchers' Night. The main objectives of the Researchers' Night are to familiarize larger public, especially young people with the scientist's profession; to show the impact of sciences such as chemistry, medical science, biochemistry, physics, on everyday human life; to show researchers as ordinary people; to bring researchers closer to the Latvian society and to attract more young people to research careers. The aim of the activities is to enhance public recognition of researchers and their role in Latvian society. Events take place all across the country, involving most of the HEIs, museums, scientific institutions and other institutions and premises.
- Since November 2017, Riga Technical University in cooperation with Investment and Development Agency of Latvia has begun publishing of a quarterly journal "Innovation" which communicates in Latvian and English about science and innovation research results and best practice examples.
- In December 2017, Ministry of Education and Science has published the first Latvia's Science Calendar "KNOWLEDGE! IT IS IN LATVIA'S NATURE", which incorporated digital video stories of 12 Latvian scientists representing 12 different fields. During 2018 the calendar

exhibition and citizen science events have taken place in major HEIs, the National Library of Latvia, the Cabinet of Ministers, the State Chancellery, and the International Airport of Latvia. Starting with 2019, it is published in Latvian and English.

- Another public media which communicates science is Latvian Radio 1 programme "Known into Unknown".

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	9	9	9	9
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	9
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	9	9	1	9
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	9	1	9	9
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	9	1	1	9

I. Any other comments

- I1 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

The implementation of ESD/ GCED is a multi-stakeholder process. There are state and municipal institutions, academic, private and NGO sectors, education institutions and organizations, media and society at large involved.

Sectoral ministries are involved at the policy planning stage and implementation coordination and support stage, stakeholders are involved into policy planning and implementation as well as they develop their own initiatives and projects and support public awareness.

One of the main challenges for the implementation of the ESD/ GCED include a certain lack of financing of the ESD/ GCED activities (particularly, for the NGOs). More possibilities for better exchange of best practice in other countries would also be an asset.

The COVID-19 pandemic is currently the main factor that influences all processes in the world, including the implementation of SDGs. Education, including ESD/ GCED is a very vulnerable sector in this situation and it is important to keep the possibilities for implementation of ESD/ GCED.

Therefore it would be useful:

- to promote the dissemination of good practice examples and development of networking, making it possible to learn from others' experience (including during and post COVID-19);
- to promote wider possibilities for obtaining financial support for ESD/ GCED activities (including for the NGO sector).

I2 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.

In Latvia, GCED and ESD is promoted at various levels and various forms of education, especially considering the process of implementation of the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

It is important to mention that the implementation of SDGs is promoted through Latvia's strategic planning system, thus ensuring coordination of various national policies and policy documents.

Regular policy assessments allow to ensure the monitoring of SDGs, including GCED and EDS, regarding both policy implementation and future policy planning.